
Lab 10

Peer Review of the Survey Research Report

Instructions

This handout will take you through the steps in the peer-review.

You **MUST** make a response to each bullet – either check or circle each bullet indicating you have reviewed that material and like what you see, or write a comment or refer the author to a comment written on the draft. If you decide that you like what you see, then, in addition to putting a check mark by that bullet include the page number of your peer's paper that shows where you found this information that you like!

As you work through the process, be sure to keep a watch for typos, misspellings and awkward sentences.

- Circle all typos on the draft
- Circle all misspellings on the draft
- Circle or otherwise mark awkward sentences on the draft and suggest an improved phrasing in the margin of the draft

Pass #1: Overall Structure and Appearance

Instructions

Review the paper briefly, focusing on the following:

- Choice of font and font size

Comments:

- Title section, positioning and information

Comments:

- Aesthetics

Comments:

- Running head & page numbers

Comments:

- Section headings (and positioning)

Comments:

- Do sections follow a logical and organized order?

Comments:

- Does each citation in the text correspond to an article listed in the reference section, and vice versa?

Comments:

Pass #2: Reading for Content

Introduction

- Does the author tell you the purpose of the study (some like to put this as a first sentence, others at the end, others in different places, but somewhere there should be a clear statement of why the research was done)?

Comments:

Consider each article cited in the introduction

Write comments in the margins of the draft or on blank pages attached to this handout – be sure to tell the author what comments go with what references.

- Is a proper in-text citation made?

Comments:

- Is it apparent to you why this reference is included in the introduction – what information the reader is to get from mentioning the article?

Comments:

- Is sufficient information given about the reference, or would more information make the reference a more meaningful part of this introduction? Also consider if too much information is given – are unnecessary details given that obscure the important information the reader needs to know about this earlier work?

Comments:

Consider the set of articles cited

- Is it apparent to you why this combination of references is included? Do you understand the “story” that the author was trying to tell?

Comments:

- Is the order of presentation of the articles “optimal” or would changing the order improve the “flow” of the material being presented?

Comments:

-
- Any other suggestions about the composition of information presented from the cited material?

Comments:

Research Hypotheses

Consider the following for each research hypothesis. Write comments in the margins of the draft or on blank pages attached to this handout – be sure to tell the author what comments go with what references.

- Is it clear what variables are involved in the hypothesis?

Comments:

- Is it clear whether the question is about correlations between quantitative variables, patterns of relationship between categorical variables, or mean differences on a quantitative variable between groups defined by a qualitative variable?

Comments:

- Is the expected direction or pattern of the results clear?

Comments:

- Is the form of the hypothesis statement appropriate? Here are some specifics to check:
 - Is a null hypothesis given rather than a research hypothesis? (*A researcher might hypothesize “no relationship” between variables; the point here is that the author should give us their expectations, not the corresponding H_0*)
 - Any reference to “means” or “mean differences” for analysis involving correlation or chi-squared (χ^2)?
 - Any reference to “mean differences between the IV and the DV” for analyses involving ANOVA?
 - Is there a reference to “in the population represented by the sample?”

Comments:

Method

The author might include all three of the following section headings, or combine the information under one or two headings. In any case, is the proper information provided and reasonably headed?

Participants

- Is the following information provided? Number and general description? How recruited?

Comments:

Materials

- Is the following information provided? Basic format of the questionnaire? What information was collected? Names of pre-existing questionnaires and appropriate citation? *(Check the hypotheses and the results – be sure that the questionnaires referenced are the ones the author actually used data from.)*

Comments:

Procedure

- Is the following information provided? Do we know where the data were collected? Do we know who collected the data?

Comments:

Summary of Sample

- Is there a summary that describes the sample?
- Are appropriate variables involved? Would you suggest deleting or adding any others?
- Is the information presented in a Table or Figure? Is that Table or Figure properly referred to?
- Is the formatting of Table 1 appropriate and clear?

Comments:

Results

Consider the following for each bivariate analysis. Write comments in the margins of the draft or on blank pages attached to this handout – be sure to tell the author what comments go with what references.

- Is it clear that the analysis is one of those proposed in the introduction?

Comments:

- Is it clear what variables are involved in the analysis?

Comments:

- Is it clear whether the question is about correlations between quantitative variables, patterns of relationship between categorical variables, or mean differences on a quantitative variable between groups defined by a qualitative variable?

Comments:

- Is the reporting of the statistical information (r , chi-squared (χ^2), F , df , MS_e , p , etc.) appropriate and clear?

Comments:

- Is the statement of whether or not there is an effect/relationship consistent with the reported p -value?

Comments:

- Is the direction or pattern of the results clear?

Comments:

- Is the information presented in a Table or Figure? Is that Table or Figure properly referred to? Is the formatting of the Table or Figure appropriate and clear?

Comments:

-
- Is the form of the results statement appropriate? Here are some specifics to check:
 - Any reference to “means” or “mean differences” for analysis involving correlation or chi-squared (χ^2)?
 - Any reference to “mean differences between the IV and the DV” for analyses involving ANOVA?

Comments:

Discussion

Telling “the Story”

Does the author clearly tell you what information is derived from the set of analyses and how it comes together to tell a story about how these variables related to each other in the sample?

- What do you like about the telling of “the story”?

Comments:

- What could the author “do better” – explain more, relate more specifically to the research hypotheses, or the results, etc.?

Comments:

Relating “the Story” to “the Literature”

Does the author relate these new findings to the literature cited in the introduction? Is it clear what replications have been made? What failures to replicate? Extensions to what we knew before this study? Converging information provided by these new results?

- What do you like about the way the story was tied back into the literature?

Comments:

- What could the author “do better” – explain more, make more explicit ties between the new and referenced findings, etc.?

Comments:

Proposing “the Next Study”

Does the author propose an interesting extension of the current study? Is it clear what this new study will look for, what results are expected, how the findings will enhance our knowledge of this area?

- What do you like about the proposed research and how it is described?

Comments:

- What could the author “do better” – explain more, more explicit description of proposed research, additional citations to tie the findings and proposal together, etc.?

Comments:

Grading

Component	Points
Pass #1 – completeness, usefulness and accuracy of comments	___ (6)
Comments/suggestions about each article	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about set of articles	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about Research Hypotheses	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about Method	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about Results	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about “the Story” in the Discussion	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about “the Next Study” in the Discussion	___ (3)
Comments/suggestions about awkward sentences	___ (3)
Total Score	___ / 30

This blank page is for you to write any comments that require space. Please be sure to note what page in the paper you are addressing so that your peer can find it. Be sure to make it easy by also noting this comment (along with your other comments) directly on to the paper copy that you are reviewing.